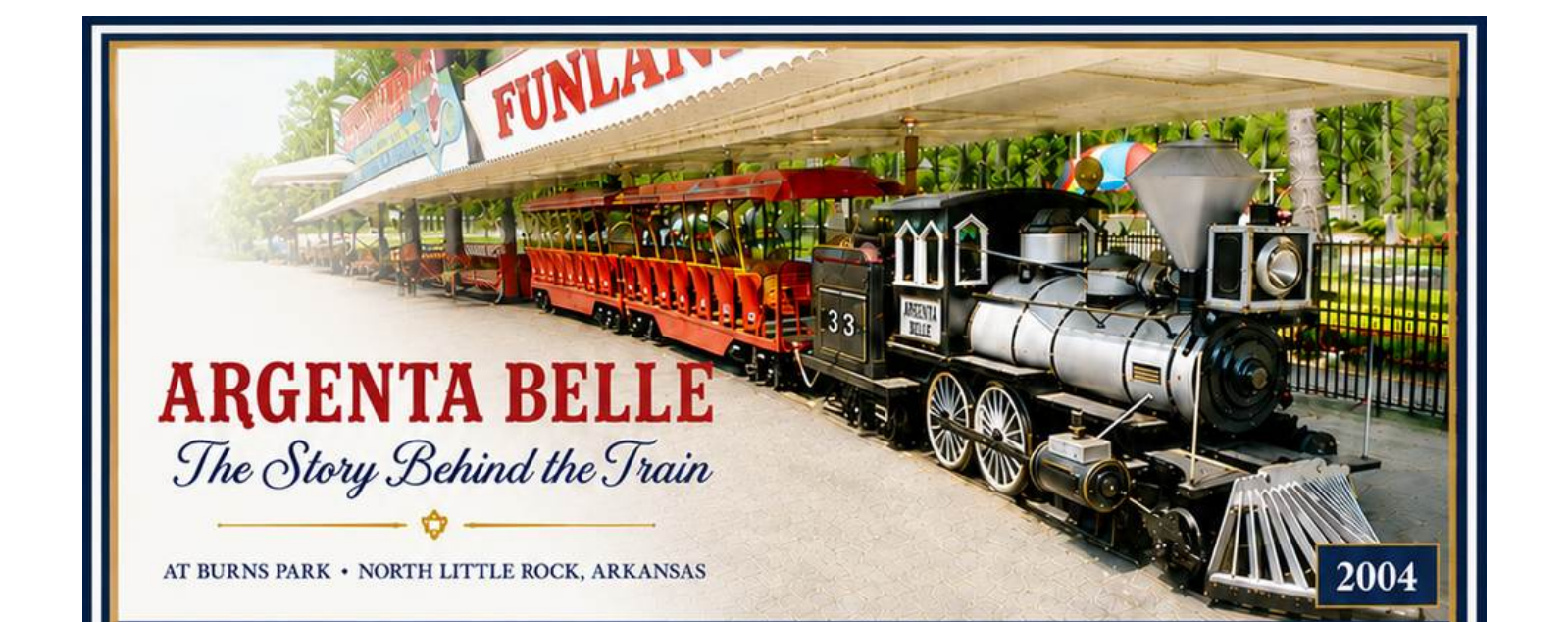




ARGENTA BELLE

The Story Behind the Train

AT BURNS PARK • NORTH LITTLE ROCK, ARKANSAS

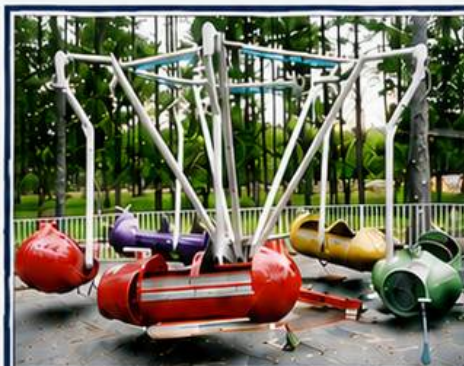
2004



★ A TRADITION THAT LASTS MORE THAN 50 YEARS

These photographs were taken in the early years at Burns Park — a time of simple rides, big smiles and memories that have lasted for generations.

*The tradition began long ago...
and it continues today.*



Photos by Susan Holly Nichols - Used by permission

For more than 50 years, families and friends have enjoyed a train ride through Burns Park. Generations have created memories that make this little train a treasured part of our community.



MORE THAN A RIDE — IT'S OUR HERITAGE

The Argenta Belle represents the joy of our past and the promise of our future.



THE ARGENTA BELLE

THEN AND NOW



Allan Herschell S-24 at Burns Park
Photographed by Clint Comeaux
(Arizona & Pacific Railroad Photo)



Allen Herschell S-24 at Burns Park
Photographed by James Talbert



Attached to the locomotive is a metal identification plate. It bears the words **IRON HORSE** and the serial number **71-250324**. The motor number is recorded as **2922**.

Only six Iron Horse trains were completed by Chance Manufacturing.

Research identifies this locomotive, serial 71-250324, as the third of those six Chance-built Iron Horses.

Correspondence from the Allan Herschell Company identifies this locomotive as a 1971 Chance-built S-24 Iron Horse, with the museum correspondence identifying it as S24-52-71 and reporting shipment on October 15, 1971, to Indian Village east of Livingston, Texas.



The original identification plate attached to the locomotive.

IRON HORSE
71-250324

1971 • S-24 •
Chance Manufacturing
• No. 3 of 6



The Argenta Belle has been a treasured part of Burns Park for over 50 years. From its early days to today, it continues to bring joy to generations of riders.

A HERITAGE THAT KEEPS ON TRACK.

THE ARGENTA BELLE

THEN AND NOW

From its origins as a Chance-built Iron Horse in 1971 to becoming a treasured part of Burns Park, the Argenta Belle has a rich history that spans decades of operation and preservation.

A

THE LEASE ERA



The 1974 lease with Burns Park Funland, Inc. listed a wide range of attractions, including a Miniature Train, merry-go-round, Turnpike, electric boat ride, Moon Walk, helicopter, Tilt-A-Whirl, Octopus, Panic Palace, Dodgem, Flying Scooter, live pony ride, Satellite and a large Ferris wheel.

A City resolution documents renewal of the 1974 lease for another five-year term in 1979. In 2001, when the owner decided not to reopen, North Little Rock moved to preserve Funland as a public attraction.



B

CITY RECORDS – 2001



2001 CITY RECORDS

The City authorized purchase of the Funland equipment for \$90,000. The contract was signed March 30, 2001, by Lloyd Choate and Mayor Patrick H. Hays.

C

A TIMELINE OF HISTORY



1971

Chance-built S-24 Iron Horse. Research from the Allan Herschell Company identifies this specific locomotive as a 1971 Chance-built S-24 Iron Horse.

1971

Texas connection. Reported destination: Indian Village, east of Livingston, Texas; associated with the Alabama-Coushatta Indian Tribe of Texas.

1974–2000

Funland lease era. Burns Park Funland, Inc. operated under a 1974 lease that included a Miniature Train; the lease was renewed for another five-year term in 1979.

2001

North Little Rock purchase. City records document the \$90,000 purchase of the Funland equipment and property from Lloyd Choate on March 30, 2001.

IRON HORSE

71-250324

1971 • S-24 • Chance Manufacturing
• No. 3 of 6



PRESERVING MORE THAN A RIDE — PRESERVING OUR HISTORY

The Argenta Belle represents more than a train. It represents generations of memories, a community's commitment to preservation, and a legacy that continues today.



THE ARGENTA BELLE

THEN AND NOW

A NEW HOME — 2001

On March 30, 2001, the City of North Little Rock purchased the Funland amusement rides and property, including the train, ensuring their continued legacy for future generations.



R-6117

FILED AM 2:30 P.M.
BY Cornie
DATE 4-2-01
City Clerk's Office
North Little Rock, Ark.
Rec'd by [Signature]

CONTRACT FOR THE PURCHASE OF FUNLAND EQUIPMENT AND PROPERTY

THIS AGREEMENT, entered into this 30 day of March, 2001, by and between THE CITY OF NORTH LITTLE ROCK, hereinafter called the Buyer, and Lloyd Choate, hereinafter called the Seller, Witnesseth:

For and in consideration of the sum of \$90,000.00, the Buyer agrees to purchase from the Seller certain equipment commonly referred to as Funland in Buena Park. The particular equipment and property to be purchased is more particularly described in Exhibit A which is attached hereto and is hereby incorporated.

The Seller **EXPRESSLY WARRANTS** that he is the true and actual owner of said equipment and property and that the subject items are free and clear of any and all liens, judgments, and encumbrances.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have hereunto set their hand this 30 day of March, 2001.

[Signature]
Lloyd Choate
Seller

[Signature]
Mayor Patrick H. Hayes
City of North Little Rock
Buyer

Exhibit A

AMUSEMENT RIDES

Helicopters	Space Shuttle	Tubs-of-Fun
Car Ride/Motorcycle	Tumpike	Haunted House
Super Coaster (Wildcat)	Mini-Jet	Boat Ride
<u>Train</u> Engine and (2) Coaches		

ADULT AMUSEMENT RIDES

Octopus	Tilt-A-Whirl	Dodgen Bumper Cars
Scrambler	Fly Plane-Scooter	

CONCESSION EQUIPMENT

(2) Sno-Cone machines	(1) Deep fryer	(1) Hot dog warmer
(2) Cotton candy machines	(2) Popcorn machines	(1) Heat lamp

BUILDINGS AND MISCELLANEOUS

(1) Office building	(1) Ticket booth
(1) Storage shed	(1) Hot water heater
(2) Concession buildings	(48) Putters
(2) Air conditioning window units	All fencing around rides
(1) Nomad RV camping trailer (G-79361, 7037-D543-L)	Miniature golf course
(1) PA System	



★ PRESERVING MORE THAN A RIDE — PRESERVING OUR HISTORY

Thanks to this purchase and the dedication of our community, the Argenta Belle continues to create memories for generations to come.



THE ARGENTA BELLE

THEN AND NOW



Your train was built by Chance Manufacturing Company (Chance Rides) in 1971 after the purchase of the Allan Herschell Company in 1970. The design is an Allan Herschell product. The chance SN for the locomotive is 71-2503-24. Our SN is S24-52-71. which represents the code for the ride S24, the 52nd one built of that design, and the year of shipment 1971.

There were 55 Iron Horse trains produced: 49 by Allan Herschell (1963-1970), and 6 by Chance Rides (1971-72).

Your train was shipped 10/15/71 to the Indian Village attraction located east of Livingston, Texas. The owner was the Alabama-Coushatta Indian Tribe of Texas. located near Livingston, TX.



Allan Herschell Company
889 Erie Avenue
North Tonawanda, NY 14120